

Donald (DJ) Wheeler

203-767-2068 • donald.c.wheeler.iii@gmail.com • www.linkedin.com/in/donwheeleriii

EDUCATION

The Pennsylvania State University

Bachelor of Science, Cybersecurity Analytics & Operations | GPA: 3.88/4.00

University Park, PA
Expected December 2026

WORK EXPERIENCE

SEVN-X

Security Consultant Intern

King of Prussia, PA
May 2026–August 2026

- Performed internal penetration tests, achieving 100% domain compromise through name resolution poisoning, credential capture, and Active Directory exploitation using Impacket and NetExec.
- Conducted external and web application penetration tests using Nmap, Burp Suite Pro, and sqlmap to assess attack surfaces and test for broken access control, SQL injection, and XSS.
- Designed and executed OSINT-informed smishing and helpdesk-targeted vishing campaigns, each resulting in at least one successful credential compromise.
- Supported a ransomware preparedness assessment by interviewing client security teams on architecture and incident response/disaster recovery capabilities and mapping findings to the NIST Cybersecurity Framework. Managed client communications and contributed remediation guidance to final reports.

Penn State University College of Information Sciences and Technology

Learning Assistant, Malware Analytics & Cyber Defense Studio Courses

University Park, PA
August 2025–May 2026

- Guided students through static and dynamic malware analysis, disassembly, and debugging using IDA Pro, Ghidra, and x32dbg/x64dbg.
- Assisted students with FLARE-VM configuration and Windows/Linux security labs, explaining analysis workflows and low-level execution concepts.
- Reinforced understanding of low-level concepts including control flow, the call stack, heap memory, pointers, CPU registers, and x86/x64 assembly.

Excelligence Learning Corporation

IT Support & Cybersecurity Intern

Shelton, CT
June 2024–August 2024

- Administered Active Directory onboarding and offboarding; automated employee onboarding using PowerShell, batch scripting, and Windows image deployment.
- Assessed Windows 11 enterprise systems against CIS Benchmarks, identified configuration weaknesses, and recommended remediation.

LEADERSHIP & INVOLVEMENT

Penn State University Competitive Cybersecurity Organization (CCSO), Red Team Competitor

September 2025–Present

- Conduct penetration tests and vulnerability assessments for clients; contribute detailed findings and remediation guidance to final reports.
- Compete on Penn State's 6-person roster in the 2026 Collegiate Penetration Testing Competition.
- Developed a purposefully misconfigured cyber range for internal Red vs. Blue exercises, deploying environment infrastructure and seeded vulnerabilities via Ansible; wrote custom malware and scripted misconfigurations as infrastructure-as-code.
- Conduct Red Team operations against CCDC competitor blue teams and within internal range exercises, operating through Sliver C2, establishing persistence mechanisms, and practicing stealth tradecraft.
- Lead Red Team workshops on web application testing, Active Directory exploitation, networking fundamentals, and Bash/PowerShell scripting.

SKILLS

Penetration Testing & Exploitation: Network and web application testing, Active Directory exploitation, social engineering, OSINT, vulnerability assessment

Tools & Platforms: Linux, Windows Server, Active Directory, Metasploit Framework, Sliver, Impacket Suite, Bloodhound, Hashcat, Wireshark, Ansible

Programming & Scripting: Python, PowerShell, Bash, Java, SQL, JavaScript